

510 Industry Pitch Team

(formerly 560 Presentation Team)

Description & Eligibility

Teams will research, develop, and deliver an investor-ready pitch for a business idea. Modeled after a real-world investor pitch, teams will present their concept to a panel of judges acting as potential investors, covering the business opportunity, target market, competitive advantage, financial projections, and growth strategy. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Entries that do not follow the provided topic, or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

PulsePeak Events is a fictitious startup entertainment company planning to launch a two-day outdoor music festival designed to attract Gen Z and young millennial audiences. The event will feature emerging artists, regional performers, local food vendors, and interactive fan experiences intended to generate strong social media engagement.

The founders believe there is an opportunity to build a festival brand focused on music discovery, shareable experiences, and strong digital promotion. If successful, *PulsePeak Events* could expand to additional cities in future years. *PulsePeak Events* is planned for a mid-sized metropolitan area with a strong youth and college population and an active live entertainment scene. Revenue may come from several sources including ticket sales, sponsorships, vendor fees, merchandise, and VIP experiences. However, launching a new festival presents challenges such as attracting attendees in its first year, securing sponsors, managing event costs, and competing with established entertainment events.

Your consulting firm has been hired to develop and present an investor-ready pitch for *PulsePeak Events*. Your pitch should explain the business opportunity, target market, competitive landscape and *PulsePeak Events*' competitive advantage, marketing strategy, revenue model, estimated startup costs, and financial projections.

Teams should present their concept as if they are seeking investment funding for the proposed venture. Teams may make reasonable assumptions where data is not provided; however, assumptions should be reasonable, clearly explained, and supported by research where possible.

Teams must develop their pitch based on the *PulsePeak Events* business concept described in this case study. Presentations proposing an unrelated business idea will not be evaluated. The focus of the presentation should be the business opportunity and investment potential of *PulsePeak Events* rather than only the event logistics.

Teams should consider elements such as:

- market demand
- pricing strategy
- sponsorship opportunities
- marketing strategy
- long-term growth potential

Team Must Supply

- One (1) copy of the Works Cited formatted according to the *Style & Reference Manual*, signed BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form for each round of the event (preliminary and final).
- Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team and must take place within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, teams may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes setup, no less than seven (7) and no more than ten (10) minutes oral presentation, no more than five (5) minutes judges' questions
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Contest Competencies

1. Analyze an assigned business idea and develop a clear, compelling value proposition that communicates the opportunity to potential investors
2. Identify and analyze the target market, including customer demographics, needs, and market size
3. Evaluate the competitive landscape and articulate the business's unique competitive advantage
4. Develop and justify basic financial projections including startup costs, revenue potential, and profitability
5. Create and present a realistic go-to-market and growth strategy for the proposed business
6. Deliver a persuasive, professional investor pitch using effective verbal and nonverbal communication skills
7. Respond confidently and knowledgeably to judges' questions, demonstrating deep understanding of the business concept
8. Collaborate effectively as a team by assigning roles and delivering a cohesive, well-organized presentation

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The use of graphics, including charts, should be part of the presentation
- Format Works Cited according to the *Style & Reference Manual*

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

510 Industry Pitch Team
Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> below:				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Market & Audience Understanding	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the target market. Audience definition is unclear or overly broad, and there is little to no analysis of customer needs, behaviors or market demand.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the target market. Audience is identified, but analysis of customer needs, behaviors, and market opportunity is general or partially developed.	Presentation demonstrates a strong understanding of the target market. Audience is clearly defined with specific segmentation, supported assumptions, and a realistic explanation of market demand, customer needs and market size.	/15
Business Model, Strategy & Competitive Advantage	Presentation lacks a clear business model or value proposition. Competitive landscape, marketing strategy, and revenue streams are unclear, missing or poorly developed.	Presentation identifies a business model with some clarity. Value proposition, competitive positioning, marketing strategy, and revenue streams are present but may lack depth, cohesion, or clear differentiation from competitors.	Presentation demonstrates a clear and compelling business model. Strong value proposition, well-defined competitive advantage supported by competitive landscape analysis, and a cohesive marketing and revenue strategy that differentiates from competitors.	/15

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Presentation Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Financial Feasibility & Growth	Presentation includes limited or unrealistic financial information. Startup costs, pricing strategy, and revenue projections are present but may lack detail, justification or realism.	Presentation includes basic financial information. Startup costs, pricing strategy, and revenue projections are present but may lack detail, justification, or realism.	Presentation demonstrates strong financial reasoning. Startup costs, pricing strategy, revenue projections, and profitability are realistic, clearly explained, and supported by logical assumptions. Long-term growth and scalability are thoughtfully addressed.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing & Documentation	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, presentation lasted no less than seven (7) minutes and no longer than ten (10) minutes. Works Cited in the correct format according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form were submitted at presentation check-in (both preliminaries and finals).			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES